

watching a movie with your friends or family, or flipping through picture albums, reliving the “good old days”—when you had time to spare, and time to care, or just listening to your favourite MP3s, it is all important. Even a ritual UT2004 frag match with friends in the neighbourhood is a great stress-buster, as is a game of Microsoft Hearts against your family. Though the possibilities are limitless, we’ll stick to those who like to be entertained in their living rooms.

The TV

The idiot box has evolved into a powerful and innovative entertainment and informative tool. The choices of channels and programmes are mind-blowing, and the technologies are advancing rapidly in order to attempt to provide you with near-real, true-to-life image and sound quality. Whether it’s “true-flat TVs” or “cinema-screen TVs”, or perhaps the choice between medium-sized Plasma TVs and huge CRTs, the choices can even get confusing at times.

However, the TV is merely the window to your entertainment, quite like a PC monitor, which is merely the visual element of a whole system of components. Just as your computing experience relies on the hardware under the hood, your entertainment relies on the gadgets that connect to your TV.

Using the right combination of gadgets, you can have an entertainment centre with no visible wires at all. As described in Chapter 4.1, you can also have the freedom to place your gadgets or devices as and where you please. You can even have the freedom of hiding away gadgets so no one sees them. Some of the gadgets you should be considering are listed in Chapter 4.5.

